SPECIFICATION OF THE CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "PALETTE"

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Palette", initially recognised by the decree of 28 April 1948.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No particular provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Palette" is reserved for still white, red and rosé wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration, the ageing and the packaging of the wines are carried out within the territory of parts of the following communes of the Bouches-du-Rhône department: Aix-en-Provence, Meyreuil, Le Tholonet. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes concerned the graphic documents establishing the boundaries of the geographical area.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration, the ageing and the packaging of the wines, is made up of the part of the territory not retained within the geographical area of the communes of Meyreuil and Le Tholonet, in the Bouches-du-Rhône department.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The white wines come from the following varieties: - main varieties: araignan B (called picardan B), bourboulenc B, clairette B, clairette rose Rs; - accessory varieties: aragnan B, colombaud B, furmint B, grenache blanc B, muscat à petits grains B, panse muscade B or panse du Roy René, pascal B, piquepoul blanc B, terret gris G (called terret-bourret), ugni blanc B, ugni rosé Rs.

b) – The red and rosé wines come from the following varieties: - main varieties: cinsaut N, grenache N, mourvèdre N; - accessory varieties: brun fourca N, cabernet-sauvignon N, carignan N, castet N, durif N, muscat à petits grains Rg, muscat de Hambourg N, petit brun N, syrah N, téoulier N, terret gris G, tibouren N.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

The conformity of the grape varieties is assessed, for the colour considered, over all of the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the controlled designation of origin.

a) – White wines: - the proportion of the main varieties is greater than or equal to 55 % of the grape varieties; - the proportion of the terret gris G variety is less than or equal to 20 % of the grape varieties.

b) – Red and rosé wines: - the proportion of the main varieties is greater than or equal to 50 % of the grape varieties; - the proportion of each of the main varieties is less than or equal to 80 % of the grape varieties; - the proportion of the mourvèdre N variety is greater than or equal to 10 % of the grape varieties. The grape varieties intended for the production of rosé wines may, moreover, comprise the varieties enumerated for the production of the white wines, in a proportion less than or equal to 15 % of the grape varieties.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.
The vines present a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare. The spacing between rows may not be greater than 2.50 metres and the spacing between plants within the same row may not be less than 0.80 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.
- The vines are pruned by short pruning (goblet or Royat cordon) with a maximum of 12 free eyes (buds) per plant. Each spur bears a maximum of 2 free eyes. - The vines aged more than 50 years (51st leaf) may be pruned with more than 12 free eyes per plant.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.
For the vines trained according to the "raised single-plane trellising" mode, the height of the trellised foliage, after topping, must be at least equal to 0.35 times the spacing between rows. The height of trellised foliage is measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
- The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 6,500 kilograms per hectare; - when irrigation is authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 6,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – The operations of disbudding and de-suckering of the plants are compulsory and carried out by exclusively manual or mechanical means. These operations are carried out before the veraison stage.

b) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the soils that constitute a fundamental element of the terroir: - total weeding is prohibited; - the addition of exogenous soil onto parcels of the delimited parcel area is prohibited; by exogenous soil is meant a soil that does not come from the delimited parcel area of the controlled designation of origin "Palette"; - any substantial modification of the morphology of the relief and of the natural pedological sequence of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works.

3° – Irrigation

a) – Irrigation during the vegetative period of the vine may be authorised, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, only in the event of persistent drought and when the latter disturbs the good physiological development of the vine and the good ripening of the grape.

b) – Any fixed installation, inside the parcels, is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

b) – Particular harvest provisions. - The use of the harvesting machine or of any other means not permitting the whole bunches of grapes to be transported to the places of vinification is prohibited. - The sorting of the harvest is compulsory in order to ensure an optimum qualitative state of the harvest.

c) – Particular provisions for the transport of the harvest. The harvest is transported in containers of a maximum capacity of 50 kilograms of grapes.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes.
The minimum sugar richness of the grapes meets the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MINIMUM SUGAR RICHNESS OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)
White and rosé wines	187
Red wines	198

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume.
The wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 11.5 %.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 45 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 45 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from: - parcels of young vines only from the 3rd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July; - parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July; - parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 2nd year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of the varieties.
The wines come from the blending of grapes or of wines in the same proportions as those provided for the grape varieties.

b) – Malolactic fermentation.
At the packaging stage, the red wines present a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards.
- The white and rosé wines present, after fermentation, a content of fermentable sugars less than or equal to 4 grams per litre. - The red wines present, after fermentation, a content of fermentable sugars less than or equal to 3 grams per litre.

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.
- The use of wood chips is prohibited. - For the elaboration of the rosé wines, the use of charcoals for oenological use is authorised for the musts and new wines still in fermentation arising from pressing, within the limit of 10 % of the volume of rosé wines elaborated by the vinifier concerned, for the harvest considered and at a maximum dose of 60 grams per hectolitre.

e) – Prohibited equipment.
Continuous presses are prohibited.

f) – Global vat capacity.
Every operator has a global vat capacity greater than or equal to the product of the yield referred to in 1° of point VIII by the area in production vinified in the cellar.

g) – Good overall upkeep of the cellar (floors and walls) and equipment (hygiene).
The cellar and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

h) – Control of the vinification temperatures.
The vinification cellar is equipped with a device sufficient for the control of the temperatures of the vinification vats.

2° – Provisions by type of product

a) – The white and rosé wines are the subject of an ageing at least until 1 April of the year following that of the harvest.

b) – The red wines are the subject of an ageing at least until 1 April of the 2nd year following that of the harvest, of which at least 18 months in wooden containers.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) – The operator has a rinsing means for the bottling circuit.

b) – In order to preserve the essential characteristics of the wines, they are packaged in glass bottles at the operator harvesting the grapes and vinifying these wines.

c) – For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before packaging. The analysis reports must be kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

a) – The operator demonstrates a specific place for the storage of the packaged products.

b) – The temperature of the place of storage is controlled.

5° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer.
- At the end of the ageing period, the white and rosé wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 15 April of the year following that of the harvest. - At the end of the ageing period, the red wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 15 April of the 2nd year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which the wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers.
- The white and rosé wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers before 1 April of the year following that of the harvest. - The red wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers before 1 April of the 2nd year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area, situated at the gates of Aix-en-Provence, is set within a cirque surrounded by woods, drained by the small river of the Arc and protected from the winds by the heights of the Barres de Langesse and of the Grand Cabri, and of the mountain of the Cengle, at the foot of the imposing rocky mass of the Sainte-Victoire mountain. The name of the controlled designation of origin is linked to the hamlet of "Palette" situated on the commune of Le Tholonet. The parcels intended for the harvesting of the grapes are precisely delimited on the formations of the tertiary limestones of the Lutetian, corresponding, in this sector, to the formations of lacustrine limestones of the Montaiguet and of Langesse that outcrop on part of the communes of Meyreuil, Le Tholonet and Aix-en-Provence, communes on which the geographical area rests. To designate these formations, the geologists also evoke the horizon of "Palette". The clayey-calcareous, stony, well-drained soils are essentially developed on the lacustrine limestones of Langesse and of the Montaiguet and on their border colluvium. The topography induces a particular Mediterranean climate, protected from the cold winds coming from the North, and creates situations of hillsides and piedmonts benefiting from an average annual sunshine of 3,000 hours and an average annual rainfall of 650 millimetres. Added to this already favourable climatic context is the moderating effect of the opening, by the valley of the Arc, onto the Étang de Berre, whose sea breezes come to temper the summer solar ardour and to maintain a slight night-time humidity, thus creating optimal ripeness conditions for the grapes. The vineyard is set at the heart of a magnificent countryside whose black spindles of cypresses, vines, olive groves and pines, emerging from the red earth, inspired the painter Cézanne.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The vine, very anciently cultivated in the pays d'Aix, was the object of a more methodical cultivation at the time of King RENÉ, a winegrower king, Duke of Anjou and Count of Provence. King RENÉ introduces into Provence the "Panse" varieties and the "muscat" grapes that still exist on the territory of "Palette". At that time, the wines of the hillsides that border the valley of the Arc enjoy a very special reputation and even the favour of the King. In 1455, he becomes the owner of the château and of the domain of Gardanne situated on the southern edge of the territory of Meyreuil. Monsignor CHAILLAN reports, in his work "King René at his château of Gardanne", numerous details about this holding that testify that the vine is the object of a particularly careful cultivation, that it extends to all the Pays d'Aix and produces more quality wines in the valley of the Arc than at Gardanne itself. We learn thus that the wines conveyed from the valley of the Arc are composed of "old wines", of "muscat wines" and of "white wines" considered as noble wines since distinguished from the rest of the orders of the "ordinary wines". Outside his own domain and in the surroundings, King RENÉ favours the cultivation of the vine. He consents to a new parcelling of the lands, among private individuals, at Gardanne, only on condition of planting them with vines (Archives of the Bouches-du-Rhône – 1472). The reading of the ancient collections of the Grands Carmes of Aix (departmental archives) teaches us that these monks of Provençal origin are owners in 1551 of the "Bastide de Meyreuil". They exploit this domain by developing the olive-oil and above all viticultural productions, applying themselves to developing the quality of the wines and brandies produced. The wines, recognised as remarkable, are already aged in underground cellars, which still exist in 2009, and that the monks themselves dug into the hill. Following the successive acquisitions, these traditions are maintained on this domain by the PASCALIS family, then by the ROUGIER family. The "Domaine de la Simone" thus comes from the various purchases made by the great-grandfathers, grandfather and father of Mr Jean ROUGIER. The first of these acquisitions dates from 1838, the last from 1896. They permitted the reconstitution, then the development, of what had formerly constituted the ancient "Bastide" of the Grands Carmes and the "Rendez-Vous" of King RENÉ. The selection of the varieties carried out by this family, the very careful vinification and the natural ageing in the underground cellars of the domain are at the origin of the growing notoriety, in France as abroad, of the wines of "Château Simone". In 1946, the ROUGIER family requests the recognition of the domain as controlled designation of origin. The controlled designation of origin being considered as a collective right, it is then proposed to recognise the ancient name of "Palette", also considering the surrounding hamlets (les trois

Sautets, Languesse…) where these renowned wines are also produced (with the "Domaine du Montaiguet", "La Dominante"…). Thus, the vineyard of "Palette", established for 500 years, is original by its varied grape varieties, constituted of classic Mediterranean varieties, bourboulenc B, clairette B, cinsaut N, grenache N, mourvèdre N, but also of more ancient varieties such as brun Fourcat N, colombaud B, panse muscade B, panse du Roy René, which have contributed to the renown of the wines of "Palette", recognised as controlled designation of origin on 28 April 1948. The vineyard counts, in 2009, 43 hectares for an annual production of 1,600 hectolitres, shared between 5 winegrowers.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The red and rosé wines are blended wines. The red wines are elaborated mainly from the grenache N and mourvèdre N varieties, with which are associated a few ancient varieties today disappeared from the rest of the southern zone. They are wines with a dark robe, with fine and elegant aromas of red fruits, frequently of leather, of cocoa, and with ample and round tannins. Wines of long conservation, they require a long ageing under wood to refine. The rosé wines are elaborated mainly from the grenache N and cinsaut N varieties, with which are also associated a few very ancient varieties. They are balanced and fine wines, which present floral and fruity aromas and possess a good structure on the palate, a guarantee of a good conservation. The white wines are elaborated mainly from the clairette B and clairette rose Rs varieties, with which is associated a palette of varieties of very ancient establishment. They are complex and well balanced, generally present floral, balsamic and pine-nut aromas, an elegant vivacity, a good length on the palate, and an astonishing keeping potential.

3° – Causal interactions

The conjunction of a dry mesoclimate with attenuated thermal amplitudes, of the topography in the form of a cirque protected from the winds from the North, of shallow soils developed on clayey-calcareous formations, and of hillside situations, confers on all of the vineyard of "Palette" ripeness conditions favourable for all of the varieties. The producers have given priority to the maintenance of a wide plant biodiversity by not yielding to any temptation of simplification of the grape varieties. In the context of "Palette", this plant diversity is the guarantee of the best expression of the terroir. The ancient varieties, meticulously safeguarded, associated with the traditional Mediterranean varieties, participate in the originality of the wines of "Palette" and in the particular aptitude for ageing that made the renown of these wines. Combining an optimal management of the plant, a control of the vigour and of the production potential reflected in practices of low yields arising from short pruning, and optimal ripeness conditions, the wines possess a structure permitting them an ageing, sometimes long and under wood, as for the red wines. In order to respect the cultivation methods, the quality and the characteristics of the raw material, the harvest is always manual so as to transport the whole grapes to the places of vinification. The wines have always been packaged and marketed directly by the operators harvesting the grapes and vinifying the wines. This, in particular, in order to preserve the finesse and the complexity characteristic of the wines of "Palette". Reflecting these usages by integrating into the production conditions the carrying out of the packaging, in glass bottle, at the operator harvesting the grapes and vinifying the wines, the producers set themselves the objective of better safeguarding the quality and the specificity of the product and consequently the reputation of the controlled designation of origin. As early as 1772, M. REBOUL, a lawyer at the Parliament, points out in his "Observations on the agriculture of Provence" that there are primary reasons: "the influence of the climate, the quality of the soil, the difference of the prevailing winds, the remoteness of the rains and of the fogs, the fluidity of the air, the favour of the exposures, the advantage of the sites…", which contribute to the quality of the wine. Antoine DAVID (in folio Aix – David 1772) affirms that "Monsieur Arnaud, innkeeper of the hôtel Saint-Jacques at Aix, owner of a bastide situated in the terroir of Aix, quarter of the Montaiguet, which he has planted partly with Mourvèdre, partly with Brun-Fourcat, produces there the wine that is preferred to all the wines of Provence by all the foreigners who land there". The wines of Le Tholonet and of Meyreuil then enjoy such a just reputation that "from the 18th century, the inhabitants of Meyreuil had the faculty of bringing their wine into the town of Aix duty-free" (Encyclopédie des Bouches-du-Rhône – XV 168). In 1906, the King of England EDWARD VII, passing through the region, makes a special detour "to come and taste the great wines of the terroir". This reputation is confirmed over the centuries. Thus, in 1948, the expert report relating to the recognition as controlled designation of origin of the wines of "Palette" underlines that "it is with pride that the wines of Palette, resting on a very ancient tradition, can align their unanimously

recognised titles of nobility". The notoriety of the wines of "Palette" has crossed history and the know-how of the producers has been confirmed. Achieving a good part of its market with the great restaurants and beyond the borders of the national territory or in export, this controlled designation of origin offers a good valorisation of its production.

XI. – Transitional measures

The vine parcels in place before 30 March 2009 and not meeting the provisions relating to the planting density continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up, subject to compliance with the provisions relating to the foliage height fixed in the present specification.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Palette" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered and accompanied by the entry "Appellation d'origine contrôlée", the whole in very apparent characters.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

A claim declaration is to be made to the defence and management body before 31 January of the year following the harvest and at least fifteen days before the first transaction or the first packaging. The defence and management body will transmit a copy to the approved control body. It indicates: - the appellation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by: - a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for the buyers of grapes and musts; - the general plan of the places of storage, permitting in particular the number, the designation and the capacity of the containers to be identified.

2. Declaration of renunciation to produce

The operator declares, before 15 July preceding the harvest, the parcels for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin, to the defence and management body. The defence and management body informs the approved control body as soon as possible.

3. Prior declaration of packaging

Every operator sends to the approved control body a prior declaration of packaging at the latest on the first day of the packaging operations, and this for each vintage and each colour of wine. The prior declaration of packaging is valid at most until 31 December of the year in the course of which it was made.

4. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the designation of origin must make the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a time limit of fifteen days maximum after this downgrading.

5. Reshaping of the parcels

Before any addition of soil, any development or any works liable to modify the profile of the soils or the morphology of the reliefs, and with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, a declaration must be sent by the operator to the defence and management body at least four weeks before the date planned for

the start of the envisaged works. The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

II. – Keeping of registers

No particular provision.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area.	Documentary check and check in the field.
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties, training method, proportion rules, entry of the vines into production, monitoring of the transitional measures).	Documentary check and check in the field.
A3 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facility. — Prohibited equipment.	Documentary check and check in the field.
Place of vinification.	Documentary check.
Place of storage demonstrated for the packaged products.	Documentary check and on-site check.
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Production potential. Coherence with the declaration of non-intention to produce.	—
Average maximum load per parcel.	Check in the field. Counting of bunches and estimation of the load from an indicative table drawn up for this purpose.
Pruning.	Counting of the number of free eyes per stock and check of the pruning method.
Cultivation condition of the vine.	Check in the field.
Irrigation.	Documentary check and check in the field.
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes.	Verification of the records (ripeness checks) at the operators.
Harvest conditions, capacity of the containers.	Check in the field.
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Control of the vinification temperatures.	Documentary check and on-site check.
Storage of the wines.	On-site check.
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Missing vines.	Documentary check (keeping of register) and on-site check.
Authorised yield.	Documentary check (check of the declarations).
Claim declaration.	Documentary check and on-site check (compliance with the arrangements and time limits, concordance with the harvest declaration). Check of the placing into circulation of the products.
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	

Packaged wines.	Analytical and organoleptic examination.

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL-SOUS-BOIS Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.08.00
Fax: (33) (0)1.73.30.08.04
Email: info@inao.gouv.fr

The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, under the authority of the INAO, on the basis of an approved inspection plan.

The inspection plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling.